

When a fellow asks to be checked in with

For CU staff who run the fellowship. No engineering knowledge needed.

The checkbox

- Last field on the end-of-session form: "I'd like someone to check in with me". Optional, no text box, no reasons.
- It's last because a sensitive question early makes people abandon the whole form.
- The form says ticking it costs nothing, and the system keeps that true.

When it's ticked

- An email goes out the moment the response is collected.
- An open row appears on the console's Help requests screen.
- No count, score or report changes.

The email

- Goes to whoever is named in `config/help_routing.json` (today the Director of Programs). Edit that file to change it:

```
"recipients": [  
  {"name": "Director of Programs", "email": "adijah@civicsunplugged.org"}  
]
```

- It holds only the fellow's name and session, and says so. The system withholds the rest on purpose: they should get a conversation, not a file.

The main rule

- **Ticking the box never lowers anything.** A fellow who ticks it weekly and one who never does have identical numbers.
- Built in three ways:
 - The checkbox is stored in its own table, never on the response record.
 - A test runs every report and export against a help request and fails if any of it comes out.
 - A second test fails if any count or rate query mentions that table.
- If asking seems to cost something, fellows stop asking.

No recipient, no checkbox

- **If `config/help_routing.json` names nobody, the checkbox is left off the form.** The session screen and provisioning history say so.
- Asking and routing nowhere is worse than not asking: everyone assumes it was handled.

Access

- The Help requests screen has its own list. Console access alone doesn't open it.

- `CUFA_HELP_ALLOWLIST` in the environment file, if set.
- Otherwise whoever is named in `config/help_routing.json`.
- The database refuses everything but the application. No dashboard, query or export reaches it.

Using the screen

- Open **Help requests**. Open ones come first.
- "I'm picking this up" records you and the time, so two people don't both reach out. "Close" marks it done.
- Both take an optional note for colleagues. Nothing the fellow typed is copied in.

```
cufa help-requests list
cufa help-requests ack --id <id> --by you@civicsunplugged.org --note "Emailed them."
cufa help-requests close --id <id> --by you@civicsunplugged.org
```

Logs

- Nothing about a help request goes into log files, at any level.

Retention (undecided)

- **CU hasn't set a retention period and the system hasn't invented one.** Requests stay until someone deletes them.
- Questions for CU:
 - How long are open and closed requests kept?
 - On close, delete, or reduce to an anonymous count?
 - Are a fellow's requests deleted when they leave?
 - Can a fellow ask for removal?
- Code marker: `TODO(retention)`.

Not done, on purpose

- No AI reads a help request. A test checks this.
- No at-risk flag, label or risk score.
- No automatic reply. A person decides.

Troubleshooting

- No email: the row is saved first, so it's on the screen. Check the address in `config/help_routing.json`.
- Checkbox missing: check a recipient is configured. The session screen says why.
- Wrong person sees the screen: set `CUFA_HELP_ALLOWLIST` to exactly the right addresses and restart the console.

See also

- `docs/setup/part-b-form.md`

- docs/decisions.md (ADR-025, ADR-026)